

# SME South Africa — Phase 2 SEO Implementation Briefs

**Prepared:** May 2026 | **Based on:** 12-month GSC data | **Follows:** Phase 1 briefs **For:** Editor + Developer | **Stack:** WordPress / Yoast SEO Premium / Tshepho's Ops Link Architect

## The Phase 2 Pattern (Read First)

Phase 1 revealed that the site's underperformance is driven by content fragmentation, not content gaps. Phase 2 confirms the same pattern applies to every remaining pillar cluster:

| Cluster                         | Pages competing for same queries | Combined impressions | Combined clicks | Avg position range |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------|--------------------|
| Tax / SARS                      | 3 pages                          | ~236K                | ~900            | 22-41              |
| B-BBEE                          | 3 pages                          | ~232K                | ~650            | 25-34              |
| Business Plan                   | 5 pages                          | ~166K                | ~1,308          | 24-34              |
| Brand partner pages (off-topic) | 3 pages                          | ~580K                | ~300            | 9-34               |

The fix is identical to Phase 1: **consolidate into one canonical page, redirect the rest, refresh with depth and 2026 accuracy.** No net-new content required for any of these three clusters.

## Brief 6 — Tax & SARS Hub Consolidation

**Priority:** HIGH — RECENCY WINDOW | **Type:** Consolidation + full refresh | **Est. effort:** 1 day editor + 30 mins dev

### Why now

Budget 2026 (effective 1 April 2026) changed two thresholds that every existing small business tax guide in SA still shows incorrectly:

- **Turnover Tax threshold:** R1 million → R2.3 million
- **Compulsory VAT registration threshold:** R1 million → R2.3 million
- **Voluntary VAT registration threshold:** R50,000 → R120,000

Any SME South Africa tax guide published or refreshed with these updated figures will immediately outrank stale competitors who haven't updated yet. This is a short window — other sites will catch up within 2-4 months.

Current state — fragmentation

| URL                                                   | Impressions | Clicks | CTR   | Position |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------|-------|----------|
| /a-guide-on-small-business-tax/                       | 152,433     | 780    | 0.51% | 21.98    |
| /sme-guides/guide-to-business-tax-in-south-africa/    | 54,454      | 45     | 0.08% | 40.92    |
| /your-biggest-faqs-on-sars-vat-registration-answered/ | 30,107      | 75     | 0.25% | 22.78    |

Three pages competing for the same tax queries. The main guide is at pos 22 — deeper than page 2, where clicks are nearly zero. The sub-guide is at pos 41 — effectively invisible. Note: tax-specific queries don't appear in the top 1000 tracked GSC queries because the site ranks too poorly (pos 22-41) for impressions to accumulate at query level — the impressions above are caught by Google at the page level, not query level. This will change once the hub page establishes authority.

Action plan

**Step 1 — Choose canonical URL (Developer)** Keep: `/a-guide-on-small-business-tax/`  
(Highest traffic, most impressions of the three)

**Step 2 — Redirects (Developer)**

- `/sme-guides/guide-to-business-tax-in-south-africa/` → 301 → `/a-guide-on-small-business-tax/`
- `/your-biggest-faqs-on-sars-vat-registration-answered/` → 301 → `/a-guide-on-small-business-tax/`

**Step 3 — Full content rewrite (Editor)** Merge the strongest content from all three pages. Target: **2,500-3,200 words**. Replace all outdated threshold figures with 2026 Budget figures. Add "Last updated: May 2026" visibly below the title.

Content specification: `/a-guide-on-small-business-tax/`

Yoast settings:

- SEO Title: `Small Business Tax in South Africa: The 2026 Complete Guide | SME South Africa`
- Meta description (≤160 chars): `Updated for Budget 2026: Turnover Tax, VAT thresholds, PAYE, income tax and how to register with SARS eFiling. A plain-language guide for South African SMEs.`
- Focus keyphrase: `small business tax south africa`
- Secondary keyphrases: `sars small business`, `turnover tax south africa`, `vat registration south africa`, `small business tax guide south africa`

- Cornerstone content: **ON**
- Author: Named author with financial/accounting background or a qualified SME accountant contributor. Add bio box.

**Schema:**

- Article (default via Yoast)
  - FAQ schema on the FAQ section
  - Note the HowTo schema opportunity on the SARS eFiling registration steps
- 

**Full H1/H2/H3 outline:**

# H1: Small Business Tax in South Africa: The 2026 Complete Guide

[Intro – 180 words]

Who this applies to (all registered businesses). What types of tax small businesses

must know about. Budget 2026 key changes summary in a highlighted callout box.

— CALLOUT BOX: Budget 2026 Key Changes (publish as a styled box/notice) —

- Turnover Tax threshold increased: R1m → R2.3m (from 1 April 2026)
- Compulsory VAT registration threshold: R1m → R2.3m (from 1 April 2026)
- Voluntary VAT registration minimum: R50k → R120k (from 1 April 2026)

If your turnover is under R2.3m, review your VAT registration status with your accountant – you may no longer be required to register.

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## H2: The 6 Types of Tax South African Small Businesses Need to Know

### H3: 1. Income Tax (Corporate Income Tax / CIT)

Standard CIT rate for companies. Small Business Corporation (SBC) reduced rates for qualifying businesses (turnover under R20m). SBC threshold and ownership requirements. Current tax tables – note SARS source link.

### H3: 2. Turnover Tax – Simplified Tax for Micro Businesses

Who qualifies: annual turnover R2.3m or less (updated April 2026).

Who cannot register: personal service providers, labour brokers, professional service

firms with >20% professional services income. Rates: 0% on first R600,000; sliding

scale to 3% at R2.3m turnover. How to register: SARS Online Query System (SOQS) or eFiling. Key benefit: replaces CIT, provisional tax, CGT, and dividends tax.

### H3: 3. VAT (Value Added Tax)

Current rate: 15%. Compulsory registration threshold: R2.3m (from 1 April 2026 – up from R1m). Voluntary registration: from R120,000 turnover. What changed: if your business was voluntarily registered under the old R50k threshold, review whether to stay registered – there is a deregistration route. VAT201 filing: monthly (>R30m turnover), bi-monthly, or 6-monthly. [Link to SARS VAT page.]

### H3: 4. PAYE (Pay As You Earn) – If You Have Employees

Register as employer with SARS. Monthly EMP201 submission. Monthly EMP501 reconciliation.

When you must register: when you pay any employee above the PAYE threshold (confirmed against current SARS table).

### H3: 5. Provisional Tax

For businesses not on Turnover Tax. Two payments per year (August and February).

Third "top-up" payment available. How to calculate. How to file via eFiling.

### H3: 6. Capital Gains Tax (CGT)

Only when selling business assets. Inclusion rate and effective rate for companies.

Not applicable if on Turnover Tax.

## H2: How to Register for Tax with SARS – Step by Step

H3: Step 1 – Register on SARS eFiling

H3: Step 2 – Biometric Identity Verification (new from 2024)

Note: SARS introduced biometric verification for all new eFiling registrations – requires camera-enabled device or visit to SARS branch.

H3: Step 3 – Register for the Relevant Tax Types

H3: Step 4 – Request a Tax Compliance Status (TCS) Pin

TCS Pin is required for all government tenders and funding applications.

[Internal link → /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/]

## H2: Tax Deadlines South African SMEs Must Know

[Table format – best for featured snippet]

| Tax type                      | Deadline                       |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Provisional tax (1st payment) | August (6-month mark)          |
| Provisional tax (2nd payment) | February 28                    |
| Turnover Tax applications     | By February 28 each year       |
| Corporate Income Tax return   | Within 12 months of year-end   |
| Monthly PAYE                  | 7th of following month         |
| VAT (bi-monthly)              | Last business day of the month |

H2: The Small Business Corporation (SBC) – Are You Eligible for Reduced Tax Rates? Requirements checklist (natural persons as shareholders, turnover under R20m, no shares in other companies, not a personal service provider).

Tax table for SBCs vs standard CIT.

## H2: How to Reduce Your Tax Bill Legally

4-6 bullets: section 12E allowances, wear-and-tear deductions, employee training (SETA/learnership tax incentives), retirement annuity contributions, bad debt write-offs.

## H2: Frequently Asked Questions

[FAQ schema via Yoast]

Q: Do sole proprietors pay the same tax as companies?

A: No – sole proprietors pay individual income tax on business profits, not CIT.

Q: If my turnover is under R2.3m, do I still need to register for VAT?

A: Not compulsorily – but voluntary registration can be beneficial if you have high input VAT costs. Consult your accountant.

Q: What is a Tax Compliance Status (TCS) Pin and why do I need it?

A: It proves you are tax compliant to government, funders, and corporate buyers. Required for all tender applications.

Q: What is the penalty for late PAYE submission?

A: 10% of the PAYE amount owed, plus interest.

Q: Can I use Turnover Tax if I also earn rental income?

A: Generally no – if investment/rental income exceeds 20% of total receipts, you do not qualify for Turnover Tax.

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### Internal links to add

#### Outbound from this article:

- → /the-basics-of-how-to-register-a-small-business-in-south-africa/ (anchor: "registered company")
- → /sme-guides/a-guide-to-b-bbee-for-businesses-in-south-africa/ (anchor: "B-BBEE certificate") — once refreshed
- → /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/ (anchor: "Tax Compliance Status Pin required for funding applications")
- → SARS.gov.za official tax pages where referenced (builds E-E-A-T via outbound authoritative links)

#### Inbound links TO this article from:

- Registration hub article: "after registration, register for tax" section
- /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/: "SARS tax compliance is required before applying"
- /sme-funding/ category hub description

#### Success metrics (90 days)

- Target position: 8-15 for "small business tax south africa"
- GSC should start showing tax-specific queries in the tracked query list once the hub reaches pos 10-20
- Click target: 3,000-6,000/month (from ~900)

Why this matters for goal #2 (funding leads)

B-BBEE compliance is a prerequisite for nearly every government funding application, tender, and corporate supplier onboarding in South Africa. A reader who understands their B-BBEE status is a warm lead for the funding portal. This brief delivers SEO traffic AND feeds the funding application pipeline.

Current state — fragmentation

| URL                                                           | Impressions | Clicks | CTR   | Position |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------|-------|----------|
| /sme-guides/a-guide-to-b-bbee-for-businesses-in-south-africa/ | 108,604     | 314    | 0.29% | 28.83    |
| /faqs-about-b-bbee-requirements/                              | 70,965      | 141    | 0.20% | 25.11    |
| /how-to-meet-bbbbee-requirements-for-small-businesses/        | 52,068      | 195    | 0.37% | 33.93    |

Combined: 232K impressions, 650 clicks, positions 25-34. Because all three rank at pos 25+, their individual query impressions fall below the top-1000 GSC threshold — the raw query data understates total demand. The queries are there; the pages are just too fragmented and thin to rank for them.

Action plan

Step 1 — Choose canonical URL (Developer) Keep: /sme-guides/a-guide-to-b-bbee-for-businesses-in-south-africa/ (Highest impressions, cleanest URL pattern for the guides section)

Step 2 — Redirects (Developer)

- /faqs-about-b-bbee-requirements/ → 301 → /sme-guides/a-guide-to-b-bbee-for-businesses-in-south-africa/
- /how-to-meet-bbbbee-requirements-for-small-businesses/ → 301 → /sme-guides/a-guide-to-b-bbee-for-businesses-in-south-africa/
- Also check: /your-10-steps-to-bee-compliance-2/ (9,442 imp, pos 27.25) — assess quality; if thin, redirect too.

Step 3 — Full content rewrite (Editor) Merge the best content from all three pages. Target: 2,000-2,800 words. Focus on the SME-specific angle — EME and QSE simplifications — not the full enterprise scorecard (that's outside the audience).

**Content specification:** /sme-guides/a-guide-to-b-bbee-for-businesses-in-south-africa/

**Yoast settings:**

- SEO Title: B-BBEE for Small Businesses in South Africa: The 2026 SME Guide | SME South Africa
  - Meta description: Plain-language guide to B-BBEE for South African SMEs. EME affidavit, BEE certificates, levels explained, and how to use your BEE status to win tenders and funding.
  - Focus keyphrase: b-bbee for small business south africa
  - Secondary keyphrases: bee certificate south africa, eme affidavit, b-bbee levels explained, how to get bee certificate
  - Cornerstone content: **ON**
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**Full H1/H2/H3 outline:**



# H1: B-BBEE for Small Businesses in South Africa: A Practical Guide (2026)

[Intro – 150 words]

What B-BBEE is and why it matters to SMEs. Core message: for most small businesses, B-BBEE compliance is simpler than it sounds – especially for EMEs. Not getting a BEE certificate costs you tenders, corporate supplier opportunities, and government funding eligibility.

## H2: The Three Business Size Categories You Need to Know

[Table – featured snippet target]

| Category                          | Annual Turnover   | B-BBEE Status                                   | Certificate Required                                        |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| EME (Exempt Micro Enterprise)     | Under R10 million | Automatic Level 4 (or Level 1/2 if black-owned) | Sworn affidavit or free CIPC certificate                    |
| QSE (Qualifying Small Enterprise) | R10m – R50m       | Levels 1–4 depending on scorecard               | Sworn affidavit (if ≥51% black-owned) or SANAS verification |
| Large Enterprise                  | Over R50m         | Full B-BBEE scorecard                           | SANAS-accredited verification agency required               |

Most SME South Africa readers are EMEs. The EME route is simple, free, and takes under an hour.

## H2: If You're an EME (Turnover Under R10 million) – Your Complete Checklist

This is the priority section – the most-searched SME B-BBEE content.

### H3: What Level Do You Automatically Qualify For?

- Any black ownership %: Level 4 (100% procurement recognition)
- 51% or more black-owned: Level 2 (125% procurement recognition)
- 100% black-owned: Level 1 (135% procurement recognition)
- Start-ups in first year of operation: treated as EMEs regardless of turnover

### H3: Option A – Free B-BBEE Certificate via CIPC

Step-by-step: log into CIPC e-services, apply for B-BBEE certificate, valid for 12 months, directors/members only (no third-party applications).  
Note: not available for companies with foreign directors – use Option B.

### H3: Option B – Sworn EME Affidavit (Commissioner of Oaths)

When to use: foreign directors, or if CIPC digital application has issues.  
Where to get it signed: local police station (free), magistrate's court, bank branch, attorney's office.

What it must include: company registration number, financial year-end turnover

declaration, black ownership percentage.  
Link to DTIC official affidavit template.  
Valid for: 12 months from signing date.

### H3: Renewal – Don't Let Your Certificate Lapse

Annual renewal required. Consequences of lapsed certificate: dropped from supplier databases, disqualified from tender bids. Calendar reminder tip.

## H2: If You're a QSE (Turnover R10m – R50m)

### H3: The Two QSE Routes

- ≥51% black-owned QSE: sworn affidavit (same as EME process), automatic Level 1/2
- Below 51% black-owned: must use a SANAS-accredited verification agency

### H3: The Five QSE Scorecard Elements

Brief overview – QSEs choose 4 of 5 pillars: Ownership, Management Control, Skills Development, Enterprise & Supplier Development, Socio-Economic Development.

## H2: How to Use Your BEE Status to Win More Business

### H3: Government Tenders

Procurement preference points explained (90/10 for contracts under R50m, 80/20 above).

Why Level 1-4 EMEs have an advantage on small contracts.

[Internal link → /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/ for funding prerequisite context]

### H3: Corporate Supplier Databases

Major SA corporates (Shoprite, Pick n Pay, Nedbank, Standard Bank, Old Mutual) all

require a valid BEE certificate for supplier onboarding. Brief guidance on the CSD (Central Supplier Database) registration.

### H3: Government Funding Applications

B-BBEE certificate or affidavit is required for SEDA, NYDA, SEFA, NEF, DTI programme applications.

[Internal link → /seda-grant-funding/ and /sme-guides/guide-to-nyda-funding/]

## H2: Sector Codes – Does Your Industry Have Different Rules?

Note sectors with specific codes: construction, transport, ICT, financial services, tourism, agriculture. Recommend verifying sector code with DTIC or a B-BBEE consultant before filing an affidavit in those sectors.

## H2: Frequently Asked Questions

[FAQ schema]

Q: Is B-BBEE compliance compulsory for all businesses?

A: Not legally – but practically essential if you want to work with government, large corporates, or apply for government funding.

Q: Can a 100% white-owned business still get a B-BBEE certificate?

A: Yes – any business can obtain a certificate or affidavit. A 100% white-owned business qualifies as Level 4 EME.

Q: Does a sole proprietor need B-BBEE compliance?

A: Sole proprietors are not registered companies, so formal B-BBEE compliance is not applicable in the same way – but for procurement purposes, they are effectively treated as 100% black or non-black owned.

Q: What is the CIPC B-BBEE certificate and how is it different from an agency certificate?

A: The CIPC certificate is free and available for EMEs only. Agency certificates (from SANAS-accredited verifiers) are required for large enterprises and some QSEs – they involve a full audit and typically cost R5,000–R30,000.

Q: What happens if I submit a false affidavit?

A: It is a criminal offence under the B-BBEE Act with penalties including fines and imprisonment.

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### Internal links to add

#### Outbound from this article:

- → Registration hub (anchor: "registered company is required")
- → /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/ (anchor: "B-BBEE status needed for funding applications")
- → /seda-grant-funding/ (anchor: "SEDA funding")
- → DTIC official affidavit template (external, authoritative — boosts E-E-A-T)
- → CIPC B-BBEE page (external link to [cipc.co.za](https://cipc.co.za))

#### Inbound links TO this article from:

- Registration hub: "post-registration checklist: get your B-BBEE certificate"
- Tax hub: "B-BBEE certificate needed alongside Tax Compliance Status"
- /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/: "funding eligibility requirements"

- Target position: 8-18 (from 25-34)
- Tax-specific queries begin appearing in GSC tracked query list
- Click target: 2,500-5,000/month (from ~650)

## Brief 8 — Business Plan Hub Consolidation

**Priority: HIGH | Type: Consolidation + template asset | Est. effort: 1.5 days editor + 30 mins dev**

### Current state — worst fragmentation on the site

Five pages competing for the same "business plan" queries:

| URL                                                         | Impressions | Clicks | CTR   | Position |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------|-------|----------|
| /how-to-draft-a-business-plan/                              | 40,354      | 207    | 0.51% | 33.74    |
| /sme-resources/business-plan-template-for-small-businesses/ | 36,424      | 541    | 1.49% | 26.75    |
| /how-to-create-a-business-proposal-for-funding/             | 33,307      | 445    | 1.34% | 26.88    |
| /ten-vital-elements-of-a-successful-business-plan/          | 30,972      | 44     | 0.14% | 24.83    |
| /the-2-main-benefits-of-a-business-plan/                    | 24,754      | 71     | 0.29% | 30.69    |

Combined: 166K impressions, 1,308 clicks, positions 24-34. No single page can escape the cluster because every time one improves, it cannibalises another.

### Key queries (from GSC):

- "business plan template south africa" — 3,036 imp, **3.72% CTR**, pos 8.86 — the strongest signal
- "business plan" (generic) — 4,107 imp, 0.85% CTR, pos 14.14
- "poultry farming business plan" — 3,666 imp, 2.43% CTR, pos 13.58 (sector-specific)
- "gas refill business plan pdf" — 1,798 imp, 3.11% CTR, pos 8.75
- "seda business plan" — 1,350 imp, **2.96% CTR**, pos 5.31 — funding-context query

Note: the "business plan template south africa" query at pos 8.86 with 3.72% CTR is the clearest signal of commercial intent. The "seda business plan" query links directly to goal #2 (funding leads) — people preparing business plans specifically to apply for SEDA funding.

Competitors for "business plan" content include generic global sites (templates, corporate tools). The SME South Africa differentiation is: **a business plan specifically formatted for South African government funding applications (SEDA, NYDA, SEFA)**. This is underserved, highly specific, and directly feeds the funding portal.

## Action plan

**Step 1 — Choose canonical URL (Developer)** Keep: `/sme-resources/business-plan-template-for-small-businesses/` Rationale: the word "template" in the URL matches the highest-CTR query ("business plan template south africa"). Also, 1.49% CTR is the best-performing of the five despite similar position — the title already resonates.

## Step 2 — Redirects (Developer)

- `/how-to-draft-a-business-plan/` → 301 → `/sme-resources/business-plan-template-for-small-businesses/`
- `/how-to-create-a-business-proposal-for-funding/` → 301 → `/sme-resources/business-plan-template-for-small-businesses/`
- `/ten-vital-elements-of-a-successful-business-plan/` → 301 → `/sme-resources/business-plan-template-for-small-businesses/`
- `/the-2-main-benefits-of-a-business-plan/` → 301 → `/sme-resources/business-plan-template-for-small-businesses/`
- Also assess the 2014 orphan "Do You Need a Business Plan, Yes or No?" — if thin and outdated, redirect to canonical; if it has a unique angle worth keeping, link it TO the canonical but leave it live.

**Step 3 — Full content refresh + template asset (Editor)** Target: 2,800–3,500 words plus a downloadable/in-page business plan template section.

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**Content specification:** `/sme-resources/business-plan-template-for-small-businesses/`

## Yoast settings:

- SEO Title: `Business Plan Template for South Africa (2026) – Free SME Guide | SME South Africa`
- Meta description: `Free South African business plan template for SMEs. Includes all sections required for SEDA, NYDA and government funding applications. Updated 2026.`
- Focus keyphrase: `business plan template south africa`
- Secondary: `how to write a business plan south africa`, `seda business plan`, `business plan for funding south africa`
- Cornerstone content: **ON**

**Full H1/H2/H3 outline:**

## H1: Business Plan Template for South Africa (2026 SME Guide)

[Intro – 150 words]

Why every SA small business needs a business plan – not just for external funding, but as an operational tool. Key message: South African government funders (SEDA, NYDA, SEFA, DTI) all require a business plan with specific sections. This guide covers both the general structure AND what SA funders specifically look for.

— CALLOUT BOX: Using This Plan for Funding Applications? —

If you're writing a business plan specifically for SEDA, NYDA or SEFA funding, jump directly to the "Funding-Specific Sections" section below.

[Internal link → </seda-grant-funding/> and </sme-guides/guide-to-nyda-funding/>]

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## H2: Before You Write – What South African Funders Actually Read First

Most SEDA and NYDA reviewers focus on four things before reading further:

1. Executive summary (can the business be described in one page?)
2. Financials (is the business viable – cash flow, breakeven, funding need)
3. Market section (is there a real market for this in South Africa?)
4. Owner's background (does the founder have relevant experience?)

Write these sections last – but understand them first.

## H2: The 10 Core Sections of a South African Business Plan

### H3: 1. Executive Summary

What to include. The 1-page rule. Common mistake: writing it first (write it last).

### H3: 2. Business Description and Background

Business name, CIPC registration number, date registered, B-BBEE status, physical address, contact details. Note: SA funders require CIPC registration. [Internal link → [registration hub article](#)]

### H3: 3. Products and Services

Describe what you sell. What makes it different. Current pricing. Why customers buy.

### H3: 4. Market Analysis

Target market (size, demographics, location). South Africa-specific note: include

township/peri-urban market data if applicable. Key competitors. Your competitive advantage.

### H3: 5. Marketing and Sales Strategy

How you will reach customers. Digital vs physical channels. Budget allocation.

### H3: 6. Operations Plan

Where you operate. Equipment and premises. Suppliers. Key processes.

### H3: 7. Management and Team

Owner biography (emphasise relevant experience). Key staff. Skills gaps and hiring plan.

### H3: 8. Financial Plan

[This section requires the most detail for funding applications]

- Startup costs (if new business)
- Monthly operating expenses
- Revenue projections (3 years)
- Cash flow statement
- Break-even analysis
- Funding amount requested and how it will be used

Note: Funders look for realistic numbers, not optimistic ones.

SEDA reviewers will challenge projections that grow faster than the industry.

### H3: 9. Funding Requirements (for Funding Applications Only)

Exact amount needed. How it will be spent (line-item breakdown).

Repayment plan (for loans) or equity offered (for investment).

[Internal link → </guide-government-funding-small-businesses/> for funder options]

### H3: 10. Appendices

CIPC registration certificate, ID copies, bank statements (3-6 months), lease agreement, supplier quotes, CVs of key staff.

## H2: Sector-Specific Business Plan Tips

[Addresses the high-impression sector queries like "poultry farming business plan",

"gas refill business plan", "kota business plan", "shisanyama business plan"]

### H3: Poultry / Farming Business Plans

Key financials: feed costs per kg, mortality rates, offtake agreements.

What SEDA looks for in agricultural plans.

### H3: Food Business Plans (Kota, Shisanyama, Catering)

Health certificate requirements. Informal vs licensed premises.

[Internal link → </faqs-licenses-and-permits-food-service-2/>]

### H3: Service Business Plans (Security, Cleaning, Logistics)

Licensing requirements section. Contract examples.

[Internal links → relevant sector-specific guides on site]



## H2: Free Business Plan Template – Fill In Your Details

[Offer the template structure as an in-page fillable outline OR as a downloadable Google Docs / Word template linked from this page. This converts a visitor into a known user – either via a link to a Google Doc template (no-barrier), or as a gated download (requires email/membership sign-up, feeds goal #3 – membership leads).]

## H2: Common Business Plan Mistakes South African Funders See

[5-7 bullets: vague market section, unrealistic financials, no repayment plan detail, missing legal/compliance docs, overly long executives summaries]

## H2: Frequently Asked Questions

[FAQ schema]

Q: Does my business plan need to be in a specific format for SEDA?

A: SEDA does not prescribe a strict format, but does look for the 10 sections described above, especially financials and market analysis.

Q: How long should a business plan be for a South African funding application?

A: Typically 10-25 pages excluding appendices. SEDA and NYDA reviewers see hundreds of plans – concise, well-structured plans outperform long, padded ones.

Q: Can I submit a business plan if my business is not yet registered?

A: Some funders will accept plans from businesses in the registration process, but most require a CIPC registration number. Register first.

Q: What financial statements do I need for a funding application?

A: For existing businesses: 2-3 years of management accounts or audited statements.

For startups: detailed 3-year projections with clear assumptions.

Q: Is there a free business plan template for South Africa?

A: Yes – download our free SA business plan template above.

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## Template asset note (Editor + Developer)

Create a clean, fillable business plan template as either:

- A Google Docs template (public link, no barrier) — best for traffic/trust
- A gated download (email required) — feeds membership/lead pipeline (goal #3)

Recommended: offer both. Link the Google Docs version freely within the article; offer the Word/PDF version as a sign-up incentive. This is one of the highest-conversion content upgrades

available for this audience.

Internal links to add

Outbound from this article:

- → Registration hub (anchor: "CIPC registration required before applying")
- → /seda-grant-funding/ (anchor: "SEDA business plan requirements")
- → /sme-guides/guide-to-nyda-funding/ (anchor: "NYDA funding application")
- → /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/ (anchor: "government funding options")
- → /a-guide-on-small-business-tax/ (anchor: "financial projections should reflect your tax obligations")
- → /faqs-licenses-and-permits-food-service-2/ (for food business sections)

Inbound links TO this article from:

- /seda-grant-funding/ (anchor: "download a business plan template")
- /sme-guides/guide-to-nyda-funding/ (same)
- /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/ (anchor: "prepare your business plan")
- Registration hub article: "after registration, build your business plan" (with link)

Success metrics (90 days)

- Target position: 6-12 for "business plan template south africa"
- Click target: 4,000-7,000/month (from ~1,308)
- Template downloads / lead captures: track as a secondary conversion metric

Brief 9 — Extended Off-Brand Noindex (Phase 2 Continuation)

Phase 1 flagged (/brands/sage/) for noindex. Two additional brand pages should be actioned at the same time:

| URL                                         | Impressions | Clicks | CTR   | Position | Action  |
|---------------------------------------------|-------------|--------|-------|----------|---------|
| /brands/afrihost-web-hosting-review/        | 201,367     | 70     | 0.03% | 9.16     | Noindex |
| /brands/nedbank-small-business-credit-card/ | 177,858     | 27     | 0.02% | 34.34    | Noindex |

Both are brand partner/review pages for products (web hosting, credit card) that attract users looking for those brands' own websites — not SME SA content. Combined 379K impressions, 97 clicks, ~0.03% CTR. Pure signal dilution.

Developer action: Yoast → Advanced → Robots Meta → noindex for both pages.

Also re-confirm the Phase 1 sage noindex is implemented before adding these two.

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## Phase 2 Checklist

### Developer tasks:

- ☐ Tax hub: 2 redirects → `/a-guide-on-small-business-tax/`
- ☐ B-BBEE hub: 3 redirects → `/sme-guides/a-guide-to-b-bbee-for-businesses-in-south-africa/`
- ☐ Business plan hub: 4 redirects → `/sme-resources/business-plan-template-for-small-businesses/`
- ☐ Afrihost brands page: noindex
- ☐ Nedbank brands page: noindex
- ☐ All refreshed URLs submitted via GSC → URL Inspection → Request Indexing

### Editor tasks:

- ☐ Tax hub: full rewrite live, Budget 2026 figures correct, FAQ schema, updated date visible
  - ☐ B-BBEE hub: full rewrite live, EME affidavit steps correct, FAQ schema, internal links
  - ☐ Business plan hub: full rewrite live, sector-specific sections, template asset linked, FAQ schema
  - ☐ All articles: named author + bio box present
- 

## What Phase 2 Unlocks for the Funding Portal (Goal #2)

By the end of Phase 2, there will be a complete pre-application journey built in organic content:

```
[Registration hub]
  ↓ internal links
[Tax/SARS hub] + [B-BBEE hub] + [Business plan hub]
  ↓↓↓ all three route to
[Government Funding hub /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/]
  ↓
[Individual funder pages: SEDA, NYDA, SEFA, NEF, NPO]
  ↓
[Funding portal application – goal #2]
```

A user who enters via any one of those top-of-funnel guides can be walked step by step to the funding application portal through internal links. Every registration, tax, B-BBEE, and business plan article should contain an explicit CTA pointing to the funding guide or application portal.

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## Phase 3 Roadmap (Preview)

The data shows a third layer of fragmented and underperforming content that Phase 3 should address. Prioritised by impression volume:

| Priority | Page                                                      | Impressions | Position | Issue                                       |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------|----------|---------------------------------------------|
| 1        | [forum] effective_sales_strategies (advice subdomain)     | 380,191     | 27.92    | Forum thread — needs article counterpart    |
| 2        | /sme-guides/guide-to-south-african-labour-law/            | 109,105     | 29.91    | Likely thin/outdated — consolidation needed |
| 3        | /how-to-start-a-cleaning-services-business/               | 100,405     | 32.63    | Stuck at pos 32 — competing pages?          |
| 4        | /sme-review/top-accounting-software-for-small-businesses/ | 151,020     | 32.04    | Review page — likely stale data             |
| 5        | /how-to-start-an-airbnb-business-in-south-africa/         | 88,969      | 26.56    | Competing with similar startup guides       |
| 6        | 268 remaining 2014 orphan profiles                        | —           | pos 20+  | Prune / redirect / keep audit needed        |

Phase 3 will also deliver:

- Monthly GSC monitoring template + KPI dashboard spec
- Content audit decision framework for the 268 orphan profiles (keep / refresh / redirect / prune)
- Link Whisper configuration review (ensure it's not creating duplicate or thin internal links)
- Yoast sitemap audit — confirm noindexed pages are excluded, custom post types are correctly configured